system started faltering as rules started to be flouted by major international actors. Finally, the whole BOP system collapsed with the outbreak of the First World War in 1914. Kaplan also suggested certain basic rules for the functioning of the balance of power system. These rules meant that one takes the following steps:

1. Act to increase capabilities but negotiate rather than fight.
2. Fight rather than pass up an opportunity to increase capabilities.
3. Stop fighting rather than eliminate an essential national actor.
4. Act to oppose any coalition or single actor which tends to assume a position to predominance with respect to the rest of the system.
5. Act to constrain actors who subscribe to supranational organizing principles.
6. Permit defeated or constrained essential national actors to re-enter the system as acceptable role partners or act to bring some previously inessential actor within the essential actor classification.
7. Treat all essential actors as acceptable role partners.

In Kaplan's view, these features would help keep intact the *balance* in relations. Failure would mean an end to balance and, ultimately, the system.

The Loose Bipolar System: The loose bipolar system, often recognized as the 'Cold War' model, envisages an international system that comes into operation when there is only two superpowers leading their respective competitive blocs and there is also a simultaneous presence of non-member bloc-actors and universal actors. Thus, this system would comprise two major bloc actors: the non-aligned states and international organizations like the United Nations. Both blocs try to increase their capabilities and are willing to run at least some risks to eliminate rival bloc. Both blocs also attempt to subordinate the objectives of the universal actors to their own objectives. Non-aligned states, on the other hand, try to support the universal actor to check the power of the two blocs and reduce the danger of war between them. Both blocs strive to increase their membership but at the same time tolerate the status of the non-aligned states.